



Document Management System



Sultanate of Oman

Ministry of Health

The Royal Hospital

Department of Pharmacy

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Title: Management of high alert medication: Heparin Policy

1. Purpose

To manage storage, labeling, supply, prescribing and dispensing of heparin products inpatient care areas, in order to minimize risk and prevent patient harm, as part of the Royal Hospital management of high alert medication strategy (HAM).

2. Policy Statement

The Royal Hospital will evaluate and limit the availability of heparin products in patient care areas in order to minimize and prevent patient harm.

3. Applicability

This policy and procedure applies to all Royal Hospital staff, members of the medical team, including physicians, nurses, pharmacists, pharmacy technicians and other persons working in the Royal Hospital.

4. Responsibility

Royal Hospital managers will demonstrate commitment to safety of all patients by ensuring that maximal safeguards are in-place for high dose heparin(s) when stocked in patient care areas.

The In-patient pharmacy services at the Royal Hospital will demonstrate commitment to safety of all patients by ensuring that processes are in place to identify, store, supply, dispense and label heparin products in accordance with this policy.

5. Principles

The In-patient pharmacy services and ward managers will evaluate and audit bi-annually to limit the availability of heparin products where feasible, and ensure maximal safeguards are in place to minimize any potential harm caused by high dose heparin products.

- In the pharmacy:
 - Heparin products will be stored in dedicated high alert medication storage areas, and the necessary auxiliary and cautionary labels will be in place.
- In patient care areas:
 - High dose heparin products [Un-fractionated heparin (UFH) 5000 iu/mL (5mL)] must be stored in a locked cabinet with a logbook in place, and a visible high alert medication label in the allocated storage cabinet must be present.
 - High dose heparin vials [UFH 5000 iu/mL (5mL)] must be labeled as 'high potency'.
 - All other Heparin strengths will be stored within a designated area for high alert medications, with a visible 'high alert medication' label.
 - If more than one strength of heparin products are stocked in patient care areas, they must be segregated from each other in the storage cabinets.

7. Supply of Heparin Products

Heparin products shall be supplied to patient care areas as per the current topping up-system in place.

Prior to supplying heparin, In-patient pharmacy services shall label with auxiliary, cautionary, and/or 'high alert medication' labeling as per high alert medication policy.

8. Storage and Labeling

- In patient care areas, high dose heparin products [UFH 5000 iu/mL (5mL)] must be stored in an allocated locked cabinet with a log book in place.
- A visible high alert medication label in the allocated storage cabinet must be present.
- High dose heparin vials (UFH 5000 iu/mL (5mL) must be labeled as 'high potency'.
- All other Heparin strengths within a designated area for high alert medications must be labeled with a visible high alert label.
- If more than one strength heparins are stocked in patient care areas, they must be segregated from each other.

9. Heparin Products available at the Royal Hospital

Heparin Product	Strength	Form	Storage Requirement	Auxiliary/cautionary labels required
UFH	5000 iu/ml (5mL)	Multi-dose vial	Locked cabinet with log book	High Potency HAM
	1000 iu/mL (5mL)	Multi-dose vial	High alert medication dedicated area.	HAM
LWWH: Tinzaparin (Innohep)	10000 iu/mL (2mL)	Multi-dose vial	Segregation of the different strengths and forms	
LWWH: Enoxaparen (Clexane)	300 mg/ 3 mL	Multi-dose vial		
LWWH: Enoxaparen (Clexane)	4000 iu/mL	Single-dose pre-filled syringe		

8000 iu/mL

10. Prescribing

The prescriber must verify patient weight prior to prescribing any heparin product.

Approved standard order sets (electronic or paper) shall be used when prescribing high-alert medications when available.

11. Dispensing

Order-entry computer systems in this hospital (Al-Shifaa system) will identify heparin products as a high alert medication to all health care professionals handling heparin products.

Prior to dispensing heparin to patient care areas, heparin products must be labeled with auxiliary, cautionary and/or high medication alert labeling in compliance with this policy and as per the high alert medication policy.

12. Abbreviations

UFH: Un-fractionated heparin

LMWH: Low molecular weight heparin

HAM: High alert medication

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Review Details

	Review BY	Review Date
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